Christian da Costa

Legal Engineering | Legal AI Governance & Evaluation | Legal Operations | Legal Data Analytics

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OAB/PR 89.297 | Master of Laws (LL.M., UFPR) | Curitiba/PR (residence) and São Paulo/SP (immediate relocation)

Portfolio: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html | *linkedin.com/in/christiandcosta*

Master of Laws (LL.M., UFPR), with over 5 years leading high-volume legal operations at the TJPR, heading a team of 8 staff; previously, tax law practice. Between Dec 2025 and Apr 2026, team productivity rose by **16.2 pp**, a reading derived from an original indicator not provided by the institutional system. **After leaving the TJPR**, the operation's material became products: PLAY, a searchable base that consolidates the institutional knowledge of a judicial chamber, with a draft-ruling builder and a deadline calculator; and CERNE, a standalone audit system for AI legal reasoning, with its own multi-model API and 25 test rounds on public decisions. Grounds for the why; traces for the way.

Projects

Instrumental Legal Knowledge Base (PLAY | ECHO) **Published 10/2026**
Documents and tools of the ECHO method (2025) | *Demo: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html#play*

- Single-entry digital playbook with unified search across manuals, SOPs, 107 legal grounds indexed by trigger (each with its requirements and limits of use), and 2,758 headnote templates.
- Conditional draft-ruling builder with 6 annotated templates, in which unaddressed gaps remain visible; business-day deadline calculator with holidays, suspensions, and official-gazette start date.

- Skills: *Knowledge Management; controlled vocabulary; document automation; Business Rules.*

AI-Powered Legal Reasoning Audit Mechanism (CERNE | ATRIO) **11/2025–Present**
Module of the ATRIO system (2025–26) | *Demo: christiancozta.github.io/arco.html#cerne*

- Standalone system for the governance of legal reasoning: audits judicial acts, including AI-generated drafts, and returns questions anchored to specific passages, without ruling on the merits; the operational expression of Legal Reasoning Governance, an original concept under academic research (DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22892157).
- Local API with *8* hard stops and fail-closed runs, with no partial report; independent cross-check of each issue, optionally across different model families.

- Skills: *Adversarial Review and LLM Evaluation; multi-model cross-checking; traceability; Python, FastAPI, SQLite.*

Professional Experience

Paraná State Court of Justice (TJPR) **01/2021–05/2026**
Legal Advisor and Chief of Staff | *Tax Enforcement and Appellate Panels (Civil, Public, and Tax Law)*

Legal AI System (ATRIO) | *Institutional use from Nov 2025 to May 2026* | *Chambers, 2nd Appellate Panel*

- Design of a four-module legal AI architecture (memory, drafting, reasoning audit, and final review), governed by versioned manuals, implemented by judicial authorization on online LLM workspaces (Claude Projects, custom GPTs, Gemini Gems): individual use from Nov 2025 and team-wide use from Feb to May 2026.
- Drafting workflow (RATIO): 3 procedural tracks and 18 phases, with gates, hard stops on missing or inconsistent input, and human validation points; first draft ruling in about **10 min** (median).
- Knowledge and data protection (CORPUS, LUX): corpus of *115,114* deduplicated rulings; pseudonymization of personal data (LGPD; CNJ Resolution 615/2025); final review that refines wording without altering the merits.

- Skills: *Prompt and workflow design; Human-in-the-Loop; Quality Gates; traceability; Privacy by Design; Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker (local API rebuilt after the operation: 31 routes, 188 automated tests).*

Legal Ops Operating Model (ECHO) | *Design and coordination from Sep 2025 to Nov 2025* **|** *Chambers, 4th Appellate Panel*

- Design and implementation, by judicial authorization, of a methodology for a legal operation with no established workflow, structured as a chain of intake, classification, distribution, verification, production, and operational memory; later handed over to the successor chambers.
- Taxonomy design: reduction of **90.2%** in classification complexity in the internal system (102 subjects into 10), with distribution across three teams; early triage of **1,192** cases in **30** days and predefined routing for **56%** of the caseload.

- ***Skills:*** *Workflow Design; legal intake & triage; taxonomy and classification; Knowledge Management; workload balancing; implementation and handover.*

Operations Management and Metrics (DATA) | *Monitoring from Jan 2022 to May 2026* **|** *Chambers of Tax Enforcement and Appellate Panels*

- Leadership of a high-volume legal operation with a team of *8* staff: pipeline and queue management, workload balancing, SLA/aging, onboarding, technical training, and mentoring; at the 2nd Appellate Panel, the completion rate (orders converted into opinions) rose from 44.2% to **60.4%** (Dec 2025 to Apr 2026), measured by original KPIs built from raw operational data, with published counting rules.
- Reduction of the time tail (over 30 days) from 36.5% to **6.7%**, increase of **23%** in completed volume (throughput), and decline of **24%** in the open backlog; in Jul 2024, review of *1,543* tax enforcement cases, with 257 dismissals.

- ***Skills:*** *KPI Management; counting rules and denominators; Data Quality; team management.*

Strategic Tax Litigation and Advisory **09/2017–01/2021**

Lawyer **|** *L. Vernalha & Moro Advogados* *Aug/2020–Jan/2021*

Lawyer **|** *A. Augusto Grellert Advogados Associados* *Dec/2019–Aug/2020*

Lawyer **|** *Domingues Sociedade de Advogados* *Sep/2017–Sep/2019*

- Strategic judicial and administrative litigation involving federal, state, and municipal taxes, with legal drafting, risk analysis, and legal opinions; tax advisory to individuals with income and assets abroad, covering international taxation and change of tax residence.

Education

Master of Laws (LL.M.) **01/2023–01/2025**
Federal University of Paraná (UFPR)

- Field: International Law
- Publications: *lattes.cnpq.br/8684392125368427*

Bachelor of Laws (LL.B.) **06/2013–06/2017**
UniBrasil University Center

Tools

Python (FastAPI, Selenium, BeautifulSoup, pandas); PostgreSQL and SQL; Docker; Ollama; OCR; DataJud API; Claude Code; Codex; Claude Projects; custom GPTs; Gemini Gems.

Languages

Portuguese native; **English** fluent (professional proficiency); **Spanish** intermediate (reading and comprehension).